

LG 2320A 23-inch Widescreen Monitor



This monitor looks like a preview of the future. Its humongous 23-inch widescreen offers an unforgettable viewing experience. You'll never have to scroll through Excel sheets or long Web pages again.

The monitor comes with an external control box, with

almost all possible connectivity options on the back panel. There's also an option for speakers on this monitor. The cables provided include a SCART cable, S-Video cable, USB cable and a regular DVI-D/15-pin D-Sub cable. You also get a full-fledged remote, with enough controls to confuse you initially. One of the available modes is the Spectacle function: this mode sets a varied aspect ratio—the central area has an aspect ratio close to 4:3, and the edges exceed 16:9.

The monitor also has the PIP function, which allows you to view a screen within a screen, but lacks an in-built TV tuner. Get yourself an anamorphic 16:9 widescreen DVD to play, pop some corn, get your favourite chair, dim the lights and you'll be convinced you're sitting in a theatre.

If you can afford it, this beauty is a must-have.

+ Wide variety of connectivity options

– No in-built TV tuner

Price: Rs 1,85,000

tant, because the first thing you need to get right is the display on the monitor. The factory settings of all monitors are not the same, and setting a monitor properly and symmetrically is the first thing that needs to be done. Curved screen edges or unsymmetrical sides are irritating. Any monitor that does this to an acceptable level, even after adjustment, is okay, but if this happens too much, you need to look further. The Microtek, for example, was bad as far as curved edges etc. are concerned.

The next series of tests involved testing the sharpness and resolution. Images shot at a particular resolution are displayed with the same clarity on a monitor only at the same resolution. If the resolution is changed, the images tend to be distorted and blocky; but this happens to a minimal extent on a good monitor. This effect is more evident with CRT monitors than flat-screen ones, and this is the point that manufacturers make when they advertise flat-screen monitors. Surprisingly, it turns out that all images we currently see at 640 x 480, are at the best resolution they can be. Going above that resolution, even the best monitors have difficulties reproducing the image—they lose out on the finer details.

The above-mentioned tests test precisely this, by running an image in coarse, fine and diagonal patterns. The fine images were more blurred than the regular image.

The results of this test are important for people who are into visual work such as CAD, CAM or DTP, since they need to

Philips 107E5

This is a wonderful package, and maintains a good balance between features and performance, without being heavy on the pocket.

The Philips 107E5 is a flat-screen monitor, and even with its great features and performance, is one of the lowest priced monitors in this category. The diagonal dot pitch is 0.25 mm, and the highest resolution supported is 1280 x 1024 at 60 Hz.

Compared to other monitors

in the same price range, the monitor

is flicker-free and the display is good. In fact, this monitor scored very well in the colour and greyscale tests, leaving the big guns behind. Features-wise, it packs in almost everything. However, the OSD controls, again, could have been more intuitive.

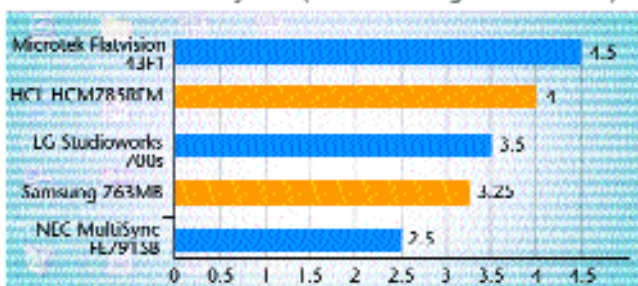
+ Low-priced, flicker-free viewing

– OSD controls not very intuitive

Price: Rs 6,300



17" CRT OSD Usability Test (Scale of 5 - Higher the better)



work with images all the time. For such users, a flat-screen monitor is best. The LGE700H and the Philips 107C5 are both flat-screen monitors that put up the best scores, beating the NEC, while the HCL HCM785RFM scored the lowest. All the other monitors, including the Samsung and the BenQ, gave above-average scores.

We also conducted colour and greyscale tests on the monitors. You can make out when colours have a more pronounced